

Package ‘SqlRender’

July 31, 2026

Type Package

Title Rendering Parameterized SQL and Translation to Dialects

Version 1.19.6

Date 2026-07-31

Maintainer Martijn Schuemie <schuemie@ohdsi.org>

Description A rendering tool for parameterized SQL that also translates into different SQL dialects. These dialects include 'Microsoft SQL Server', 'Oracle', 'PostgreSQL', 'Amazon RedShift', 'Apache Impala', 'IBM Netezza', 'Google BigQuery', 'Microsoft PDW', 'Snowflake', 'Azure Synapse Analytics Dedicated', 'Apache Spark', 'SQLite', and 'InterSystems IRIS'.

SystemRequirements Java (>= 8)

License Apache License 2.0

VignetteBuilder knitr

URL <https://ohdsi.github.io/SqlRender/>, <https://github.com/OHDSI/SqlRender>

BugReports <https://github.com/OHDSI/SqlRender/issues>

Imports rJava,
rlang,
checkmate

Suggests testthat,
knitr,
rmarkdown,
shiny,
shinydashboard

Encoding UTF-8

Config/roxygen2/version 8.0.0

Contents

camelCaseToSnakeCase	2
camelCaseToSnakeCaseNames	3
camelCaseToTitleCase	3
createRWrapperForSql	4
getTempTablePrefix	5
launchSqlRenderDeveloper	5

listSupportedDialects	6
loadRenderTranslateSql	6
readSql	7
render	8
renderSql	9
renderSqlFile	10
snakeCaseToCamelCase	11
snakeCaseToCamelCaseNames	11
sparkHandleInsert	12
splitSql	12
supportsJava8	13
translate	13
translateSingleStatement	14
translateSql	15
translateSqlFile	15
writeSql	16
Index	18

camelCaseToSnakeCase	<i>Convert a camel case string to snake case</i>
----------------------	--

Description

Convert a camel case string to snake case

Usage

camelCaseToSnakeCase(string)

Arguments

string	The string to be converted
--------	----------------------------

Value

A string

Examples

camelCaseToSnakeCase("exposureConceptId1")

`camelCaseToSnakeCaseNames`*Convert the names of an object from camel case to snake case*

Description

Convert the names of an object from camel case to snake case

Usage

```
camelCaseToSnakeCaseNames(object)
```

Arguments

`object` The object of which the names should be converted

Value

The same object, but with converted names.

Examples

```
x <- data.frame(conceptId = 1, conceptName = "b")
camelCaseToSnakeCaseNames(x)
```

`camelCaseToTitleCase` *Convert a camel case string to title case*

Description

Convert a camel case string to title case

Usage

```
camelCaseToTitleCase(string)
```

Arguments

`string` The string to be converted

Value

A string

Examples

```
camelCaseToTitleCase("exposureConceptId1")
```

`createRWrapperForSql` *Create an R wrapper for SQL*

Description

`createRWrapperForSql` creates an R wrapper for a parameterized SQL file. The created R script file will contain a single function, that executes the SQL, and accepts the same parameters as specified in the SQL.

Usage

```
createRWrapperForSql(  
  sqlFilename,  
  rFilename,  
  packageName,  
  createRoxygenTemplate = TRUE  
)
```

Arguments

<code>sqlFilename</code>	The SQL file.
<code>rFilename</code>	The name of the R file to be generated. Defaults to the name of the SQL file with the extension reset to R.
<code>packageName</code>	The name of the package that will contains the SQL file.
<code>createRoxygenTemplate</code>	If true, a template of Roxygen comments will be added.

Details

This function reads the declarations of defaults in the parameterized SQL file, and creates an R function that exposes the parameters. It uses the `loadRenderTranslateSql` function, and assumes the SQL will be used inside a package. To use inside a package, the SQL file should be placed in the `inst/sql/sql_server` folder of the package.

Examples

```
## Not run:  
# This will create a file called CohortMethod.R:  
createRWrapperForSql("CohortMethod.sql", packageName = "CohortMethod")  
  
## End(Not run)
```

getTempTablePrefix	<i>Get the prefix used for emulated temp tables for DBMSs that do not support temp tables (e.g. Oracle, BigQuery).</i>
--------------------	--

Description

Get the prefix used for emulated temp tables for DBMSs that do not support temp tables (e.g. Oracle, BigQuery).

Usage

```
getTempTablePrefix()
```

Value

The prefix string.

Examples

```
getTempTablePrefix()
```

launchSqlRenderDeveloper	<i>Launch the SqlRender Developer Shiny app</i>
--------------------------	---

Description

Launch the SqlRender Developer Shiny app

Usage

```
launchSqlRenderDeveloper(launch.browser = TRUE)
```

Arguments

`launch.browser` Should the app be launched in your default browser, or in a Shiny window. Note: copying to clipboard will not work in a Shiny window.

Details

Launches a Shiny app that allows the user to develop SQL and see how it translates to the supported dialects.

`listSupportedDialects` *List the supported target dialects*

Description

List the target dialects supported by the `translate` function.

Usage

```
listSupportedDialects()
```

Value

A data frame with two columns. The 'dialect' column contains the abbreviation used in `SqlRender`, and the 'description' column contains a more human-readable description.

Examples

```
listSupportedDialects()
```

`loadRenderTranslateSql`
Load, render, and translate a SQL file in a package

Description

`loadRenderTranslateSql` Loads a SQL file contained in a package, renders it and translates it to the specified dialect

Usage

```
loadRenderTranslateSql(
  sqlFilename,
  packageName,
  dbms = "sql server",
  ...,
  tempEmulationSchema = getOption("sqlRenderTempEmulationSchema"),
  oracleTempSchema = NULL,
  warnOnMissingParameters = TRUE
)
```

Arguments

<code>sqlFilename</code>	The source SQL file
<code>packageName</code>	The name of the package that contains the SQL file
<code>dbms</code>	The target dialect. Currently 'sql server', 'oracle', 'postgres', and 'redshift' are supported
<code>...</code>	Parameter values used for render

tempEmulationSchema

Some database platforms like Oracle and Impala do not truly support temp tables. To emulate temp tables, provide a schema with write privileges where temp tables can be created.

oracleTempSchema

DEPRECATED: use tempEmulationSchema instead.

warnOnMissingParameters

Should a warning be raised when parameters provided to this function do not appear in the parameterized SQL that is being rendered? By default, this is TRUE.

Details

This function looks for a SQL file with the specified name in the inst/sql/<dbms> folder of the specified package. If it doesn't find it in that folder, it will try and load the file from the inst/sql or inst/sql/sql_server folder and use the translate function to translate it to the requested dialect. It will subsequently call the render function with any of the additional specified parameters.

Value

Returns a string containing the rendered SQL.

Examples

```
## Not run:
renderedSql <- loadRenderTranslateSql("CohortMethod.sql",
  packageName = "CohortMethod",
  dbms = connectionDetails$dbms,
  CDM_schema = "cdmSchema"
)

## End(Not run)
```

readSql

Reads a SQL file

Description

readSql loads SQL from a file

Usage

```
readSql(sourceFile)
```

Arguments

sourceFile The source SQL file

Details

readSql loads SQL from a file

Value

Returns a string containing the SQL.

Examples

```
## Not run:
readSql("myParamStatement.sql")

## End(Not run)
```

render	<i>Render SQL code based on parameterized SQL and parameter values</i>
--------	--

Description

render Renders SQL code based on parameterized SQL and parameter values.

Usage

```
render(sql, warnOnMissingParameters = TRUE, ...)
```

Arguments

sql	The parameterized SQL
warnOnMissingParameters	Should a warning be raised when parameters provided to this function do not appear in the parameterized SQL that is being rendered? By default, this is TRUE.
...	Parameter values

Details

This function takes parameterized SQL and a list of parameter values and renders the SQL that can be send to the server. Parameterization syntax:

@parameterName Parameters are indicated using a @ prefix, and are replaced with the actual values provided in the render call.

{DEFAULT @parameterName = parameterValue} Default values for parameters can be defined using curly and the DEFAULT keyword.

{if}?{then}:{else} The if-then-else pattern is used to turn on or off blocks of SQL code.

Value

A character string containing the rendered SQL.

Examples

```
render("SELECT * FROM @a;", a = "myTable")
render("SELECT * FROM @a {@b}??{WHERE x = 1};", a = "myTable", b = "true")
render("SELECT * FROM @a {@b == ''}??{WHERE x = 1}:{ORDER BY x};", a = "myTable", b = "true")
render("SELECT * FROM @a {@b != ''}??{WHERE @b = 1};", a = "myTable", b = "y")
render("SELECT * FROM @a {1 IN (@c)}??{WHERE @b = 1};",
  a = "myTable",
  b = "y",
  c = c(1, 2, 3, 4)
)
render("{DEFAULT @b = \"someField\"}SELECT * FROM @a {@b != ''}??{WHERE @b = 1};",
  a = "myTable"
)
render("SELECT * FROM @a {@a == 'myTable' & @b != 'x'}??{WHERE @b = 1};",
  a = "myTable",
  b = "y"
)
render(
  sql = "SELECT * FROM @a;",
  warnOnMissingParameters = FALSE,
  a = "myTable",
  b = "missingParameter"
)
```

renderSql

Deprecated: Render SQL code based on parameterized SQL and parameter values

Description

This function has been deprecated. Use [render](#) instead. This new function returns a character vector instead of a list.

Usage

```
renderSql(sql = "", warnOnMissingParameters = TRUE, ...)
```

Arguments

sql	The parameterized SQL
warnOnMissingParameters	Should a warning be raised when parameters provided to this function do not appear in the parameterized SQL that is being rendered? By default, this is TRUE.
...	Parameter values

Value

A list containing the following elements:

parameterizedSql The original parameterized SQL code

sql The rendered sql

renderSqlFile	<i>Render a SQL file</i>
---------------	--------------------------

Description

renderSqlFile Renders SQL code in a file based on parameterized SQL and parameter values, and writes it to another file.

Usage

```
renderSqlFile(sourceFile, targetFile, warnOnMissingParameters = TRUE, ...)
```

Arguments

sourceFile	The source SQL file
targetFile	The target SQL file
warnOnMissingParameters	Should a warning be raised when parameters provided to this function do not appear in the parameterized SQL that is being rendered? By default, this is TRUE.
...	Parameter values

Details

This function takes parameterized SQL and a list of parameter values and renders the SQL that can be send to the server. Parameterization syntax:

@parameterName Parameters are indicated using a @ prefix, and are replaced with the actual values provided in the render call.

{DEFAULT @parameterName = parameterValue} Default values for parameters can be defined using curly and the DEFAULT keyword.

{if}?{then}:{else} The if-then-else pattern is used to turn on or off blocks of SQL code.

Examples

```
## Not run:
renderSqlFile("myParamStatement.sql", "myRenderedStatement.sql", a = "myTable")

## End(Not run)
```

snakeCaseToCamelCase *Convert a snake case string to camel case*

Description

Convert a snake case string to camel case

Usage

```
snakeCaseToCamelCase(string)
```

Arguments

string The string to be converted

Value

A string

Examples

```
snakeCaseToCamelCase("exposure_concept_id_1")
```

snakeCaseToCamelCaseNames
 Convert the names of an object from snake case to camel case

Description

Convert the names of an object from snake case to camel case

Usage

```
snakeCaseToCamelCaseNames(object)
```

Arguments

object The object of which the names should be converted

Value

The same object, but with converted names.

Examples

```
x <- data.frame(concept_id = 1, concept_name = "b")
snakeCaseToCamelCaseNames(x)
```

sparkHandleInsert	<i>Handles Spark Inserts</i>
-------------------	------------------------------

Description

This function is for Spark connections only, it handles insert commands, as Spark cannot handle inserts with aliased or subset columns.

Usage

```
sparkHandleInsert(sql, connection)
```

Arguments

sql	The SQL to be translated.
connection	The connection to the database server.

Value

A sql string with INSERT command modified to contain the full column list, padded with NULLS as needed.

splitSql	<i>Split a single SQL string into one or more SQL statements</i>
----------	--

Description

splitSql splits a string containing multiple SQL statements into a vector of SQL statements

Usage

```
splitSql(sql)
```

Arguments

sql	The SQL string to split into separate statements
-----	--

Details

This function is needed because some DBMSs (like ORACLE) do not accept multiple SQL statements being sent as one execution.

Value

A vector of strings, one for each SQL statement

Examples

```
splitSql("SELECT * INTO a FROM b; USE x; DROP TABLE c;")
```

supportsJava8	<i>Determine if Java virtual machine supports Java</i>
---------------	--

Description

Tests Java virtual machine (JVM) java.version system property to check if version >= 8.

Usage

```
supportsJava8()
```

Value

Returns TRUE if JVM supports Java >= 8.

Examples

```
supportsJava8()
```

translate	<i>Translates SQL from one dialect to another</i>
-----------	---

Description

translate translates SQL from one dialect to another.

Usage

```
translate(
  sql,
  targetDialect,
  tempEmulationSchema = getOption("sqlRenderTempEmulationSchema"),
  oracleTempSchema = NULL
)
```

Arguments

sql	The SQL to be translated
targetDialect	The target dialect. Currently "oracle", "postgresql", "pdw", "impala", "sqlite", "sqlite extended", "netezza", "bigquery", "snowflake", "synapse", "spark", "redshift", and "iris" are supported. Use listSupportedDialects to get the list of supported dialects.
tempEmulationSchema	Some database platforms like Oracle and Impala do not truly support temp tables. To emulate temp tables, provide a schema with write privileges where temp tables can be created.
oracleTempSchema	DEPRECATED: use tempEmulationSchema instead.

Details

This function takes SQL in one dialect and translates it into another. It uses simple pattern replacement, so its functionality is limited. Note that trailing semicolons are not removed for Oracle, which is required before sending a statement through JDBC. This will be done by [splitSql](#).

Value

A character string containing the translated SQL.

Examples

```
translate("USE my_schema;", targetDialect = "oracle")
```

```
translateSingleStatement
```

Translates a single SQL statement from one dialect to another

Description

`translateSingleStatement` translates a single SQL statement from one dialect to another.

Usage

```
translateSingleStatement(
  sql = "",
  targetDialect,
  tempEmulationSchema = getOption("sqlRenderTempEmulationSchema"),
  oracleTempSchema = NULL
)
```

Arguments

<code>sql</code>	The SQL to be translated
<code>targetDialect</code>	The target dialect. Currently "oracle", "postgresql", "pdw", "impala", "sqlite", "sqlite extended", "netezza", "bigquery", "snowflake", "synapse", "spark", "redshift", and "iris" are supported.
<code>tempEmulationSchema</code>	Some database platforms like Oracle and Impala do not truly support temp tables. To emulate temp tables, provide a schema with write privileges where temp tables can be created.
<code>oracleTempSchema</code>	DEPRECATED: use <code>tempEmulationSchema</code> instead.

Details

This function takes SQL in one dialect and translates it into another. It uses simple pattern replacement, so its functionality is limited. This removes any trailing semicolon as required by Oracle when sending through JDBC. An error is thrown if more than one statement is encountered in the SQL.

Value

A character vector with the translated SQL.

Examples

```
translateSingleStatement("USE my_schema;", targetDialect = "oracle")
```

translateSql	<i>Deprecated: Translates SQL from one dialect to another</i>
--------------	---

Description

This function has been deprecated. Use [translate](#) instead. This new function returns a character vector instead of a list.

Usage

```
translateSql(sql = "", targetDialect, oracleTempSchema = NULL)
```

Arguments

sql	The SQL to be translated
targetDialect	The target dialect. Currently "oracle", "postgresql", "pdw", "impala", "netezza", "bigquery", "snowflake", "synapse", "spark", "redshift", and "iris" are supported
oracleTempSchema	A schema that can be used to create temp tables in when using Oracle or Impala.

Value

A list containing the following elements:

originalSql The original parameterized SQL code

sql The translated SQL

translateSqlFile	<i>Translate a SQL file</i>
------------------	-----------------------------

Description

This function takes SQL and translates it to a different dialect.

Usage

```
translateSqlFile(
  sourceFile,
  targetFile,
  targetDialect,
  tempEmulationSchema = getOption("sqlRenderTempEmulationSchema"),
  oracleTempSchema = NULL
)
```

Arguments

sourceFile	The source SQL file
targetFile	The target SQL file
targetDialect	The target dialect. Currently "oracle", "postgresql", "pdw", "impala", "sqlite", "netezza", "bigquery", "snowflake", "synapse", "spark", "redshift" and "iris" are supported.
tempEmulationSchema	Some database platforms like Oracle and Impala do not truly support temp tables. To emulate temp tables, provide a schema with write privileges where temp tables can be created.
oracleTempSchema	DEPRECATED: use tempEmulationSchema instead.

Details

This function takes SQL and translates it to a different dialect.

Examples

```
## Not run:
translateSqlFile("myRenderedStatement.sql",
  "myTranslatedStatement.sql",
  targetDialect = "postgresql"
)

## End(Not run)
```

writeSql	<i>Write SQL to a SQL (text) file</i>
----------	---------------------------------------

Description

writeSql writes SQL to a file

Usage

```
writeSql(sql, targetFile)
```

Arguments

sql	A string containing the sql
targetFile	The target SQL file

Details

writeSql writes SQL to a file

Examples

```
## Not run:  
sql <- "SELECT * FROM @table_name"  
writeSql(sql, "myParamStatement.sql")  
  
## End(Not run)
```

Index

camelCaseToSnakeCase, [2](#)
camelCaseToSnakeCaseNames, [3](#)
camelCaseToTitleCase, [3](#)
createRWrapperForSql, [4](#)

getTempTablePrefix, [5](#)

launchSqlRenderDeveloper, [5](#)
listSupportedDialects, [6](#), [13](#)
loadRenderTranslateSql, [6](#)

readSql, [7](#)
render, [8](#), [9](#)
renderSql, [9](#)
renderSqlFile, [10](#)

snakeCaseToCamelCase, [11](#)
snakeCaseToCamelCaseNames, [11](#)
sparkHandleInsert, [12](#)
splitSql, [12](#), [14](#)
supportsJava8, [13](#)

translate, [6](#), [13](#), [15](#)
translateSingleStatement, [14](#)
translateSql, [15](#)
translateSqlFile, [15](#)

writeSql, [16](#)